

glasses-free 3-D viewing more practical. The new lens is thinner at the bottom than at the top. It steers light to a viewer's eyes by switching LEDs along its bottom edge on and off. Combined with a backlight, this makes it possible to show different images to different viewers, or to create a 3-D effect by presenting different images to a person's left and right eye.

"What's so special about this lens is that it allows us to control where the light goes," says Steven Bathiche, director of Microsoft's Applied Sciences Group.

3-D-capable laptop

Toshiba claims to have launched the world's first notebook featuring playback of 3-D content in Blu-ray 3-D format. Based around a 3-D system from NVIDIA, the Dynabook TX/98MBL features a 39.6cm (15.6-inch) wide LCD with LED backlighting and a 120Hz scan rate. It employs WinDVD BD to play content in Blu-ray 3-D format and NVIDIA 3-D Vision software and hardware. The system's active-shutter LCD glasses lighten and darken at the fast refresh rate of the 120Hz LCD, with an effective refresh rate of 60 Hz for each eye. As each eye receives a slightly different image, the result is a dynamic stereoscopic image.

Other specifications include 4 GB of RAM with the option to upgrade

to 8 GB, a 640GB hard drive, a Blu-ray burner, a pair of built-in Harman/Kardon stereo speakers and Dolby Advanced. The notebook also features 802.11 b/g/n WiFi, plus Ethernet, one HDMI port and a 3.3-megapixel camera. It is equipped with Intel's Core i7-740QM processor and comes pre-installed with the latest version of Microsoft Office Home and Business 2010.

Bicycle-powered charger

Now you can use your Nokia phone without worrying about battery life. Nokia, the world's largest maker of cellphones, has launched a bicycle-powered charger to provide free and environment-friendly electricity for mobile phones. The Nokia bicycle charger kit consists of a charger and dynamo, as well as a holder to secure the phone to the bike. When the kit is installed, the dynamo—a small electrical generator—uses the movement of the wheels to charge the handset through the standard 2mm charging jack used in most Nokia mobile phones.

According to the company, users will get free and efficient charging from cycling as the dynamo starts charging when a bicycle speed of 6 kmph is reached and stops at 50 kmph, matching the efficiency of a normal charger when the bike is travelling at 12 kmph.

The bicycle charger kit will be available before the end of the year,

with an \$18 price tag.

Impact of multitouch devices on humans

Considered to be high on utility, multitouch devices like iPhone and iPad are in vogue, currently. But little is known about the impact that finger-flicking may have on humans. Researchers at Arizona State University have undertaken a research project to study whether the long-term use of multitouch devices could cause musculoskeletal disorders.

Initially, users will be fitted with electromyography equipment to measure muscle forces and with cyber gloves to record their hand movements while they interact with multitouch systems. The second phase of the project will involve development of biomechanical models that show how much stress is created by certain gestures.

This data would be given to Microsoft, Apple and other manufacturers so that they could use it when they design new devices.

Goodbye typing, hello swiping

With Swype, you can now say goodbye to typing extensive messages on your not-so-convenient smartphone. Developed by Cliff Kushler, the inventor of T9 text input software, Swype provides



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